

Miners' Loss Blamed On Umpire

By MARK LEIBSON

Times Sports Writer

University of Texas at El Paso coach Andy Cohen blasted home plate umpire Scott Ehret for causing the Miners a 9-6 loss to Colorado State Monday at Dudley Field.

"That guy behind the plate was . . . poor," charged Cohen. "He was taking a lot of strikes away from Nick (Fiorillo) there in the ninth and there was no reason for him to throw Nick out of the game."

The game turned into turmoil in the top of the ninth after UTEP rallied for five runs the inning before to take a 6-5 advantage.

Fiorillo, a hard-throwing southpaw with a dropping curve ball, kept the ball low to the first two batters he faced in the ninth. Ehret, who had been calling strikes in the exact area the entire game, changed course in midstream and started calling Fiorillo's pitches balls.

"It's a shame this had to happen to the kids because they made one helluva comeback there in the eighth

and deserved to win this game," said Cohen.

After Galen Kitzmura and Nick DeGennaro were issued free passes to the base paths, Tony Antonini's attempted sacrifice bunt fell out of the out-reached glove of Miner first baseman Dan Feagler for an error, loading the bases with no outs.

Wes Zotz, who had won two games over the weekend with a relief appearance Friday and a complete nine-inning stint Saturday, was called to the mound again but was tagged with a Jim Bryan double which landed squarely on the chalk lines down the left field line, scoring the tying and go-ahead runners.

Eric Kurosawa knocked in two more runs with a single up the middle for Colorado State.

Zotz' appearance was not planned by Cohen but after Fiorillo had been thrown out of the game for "unsportsmanlike language" by Ehret, Cohen had no other choice than to bring in the over-worked Zotz.

"Fiorillo was talking to me about

the umpire when he was thrown out. He wasn't talking to the ump but the umpire told me Nick was attacking his character," Cohen said.

UTEP scored first in the third when third baseman Rick Cramer walked, moved to second on a wild pitch, advanced to third on Bill Roberts' short single to left and scored on a fly to deep right field by Art Bravo.

Colorado State, now 5-5 for the season, began its scoring an inning later when Jack Upton doubled to right-center off UTEP starter K. C. Nix and scored on back-to-back singles by Jim Bryan and Kurosawa. Alert UTEP wiped out a potential CSU run in the same inning when Nix appealed at third base that Byran left too soon when tagging on a fly to center by Bernard Brown.

The Rams broke the game open with a run in the sixth and three more in the seventh but the Miners battled back to take a one-run lead in the eighth with a five-run rally on four singles and a pair of costly CSU errors.

With one out, Bravo singled and moved to second on a wild pitch. After UTEP made its second out, Bob Alsup hit an opposite field single to left scoring Bravo. When Dan Feagler walked, Rams' coach Tom Wheeler sent Robert Brogan in to releave starter Bill Moren.

Rich Hildebrand slapped a high bouncer to Upton at first who threw the ball past Brogan who was covering the bag, allowing Alsup to score with Feagler and Hildebrand moving up to third and second respectively.

Danny Haygood continued the comeback with a two-run single to right-center followed by another two-run single by Rick Perez in the same location to give the Miners the lead.

The two teams return to Dudley Field noon Tuesday to conclude the three-game series with a doubleheader. Jerry Walker and Jim Sacco will start on the mound for UTEP.

Colorado State 9, UTEP 6
CSU 000 101 204-9 10 2
UTEP 001 000 050-4 9 2
Bill Moren, Robert Brogan (8) and Bill Blak; K. C. Nix, Nick Fiorillo (7), Wes Zotz (9) and Rich Hildebrand. W — Brogan (2-0). L — Fiorillo (2-2).